The first wall: what we knew and assumed

We began by separating the brief's claims from our own assumptions and the questions that required evidence. The photographs preserve that early uncertainty.

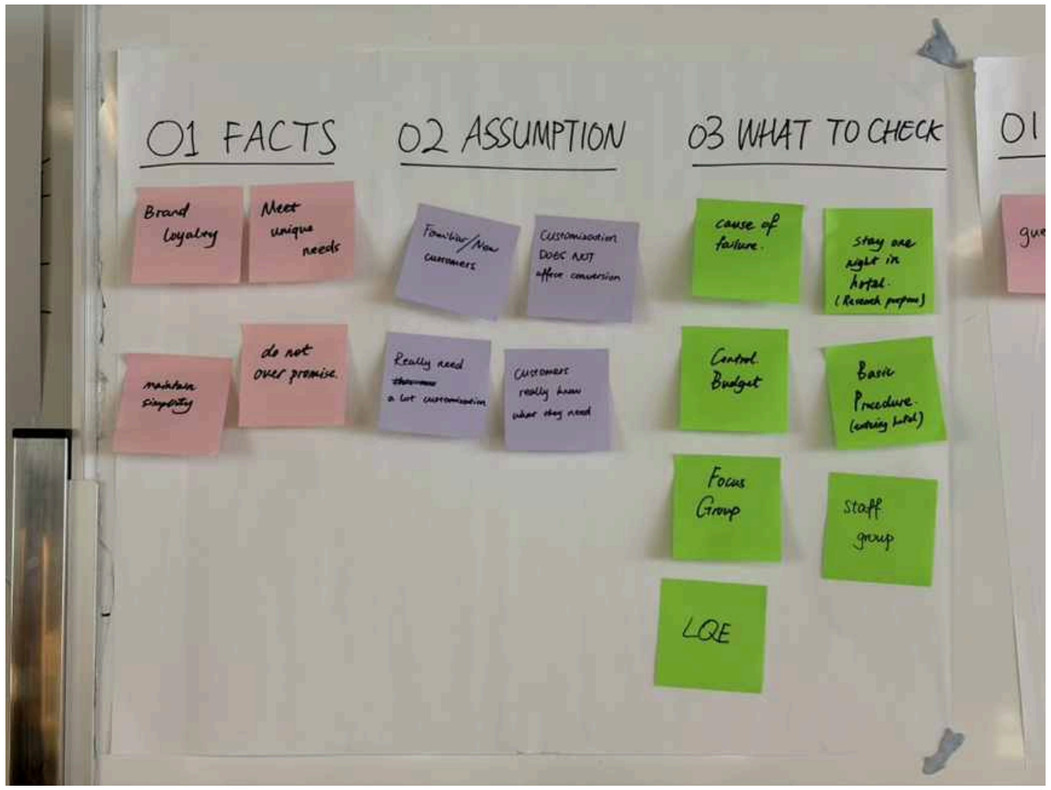


Fig. A1. Facts / Assumptions / What we need to check. Original wall photograph.



Fig. A2. Who is named / who is missing, and our early intent. Original wall photograph.

Why we kept this artefact

The exercise forced us to distinguish what the assigned brief had already stated from what we still needed to learn. Operational complexity was given in the brief. Guest motivations, preferred channels and what "feeling at home" meant were still open questions.

The wall is evidence of our framing process. It is not independent evidence that the assumptions written on its notes were true.

From a guest-only frame to a service relationship

We began with the staying guest, then examined the assistant and the hotel teams who translate and deliver the request. This helped us see why the person using a booking interface might not be the person who experiences the room.

The later assistant interview broadened the chain again: procurement, travel platforms, local hosts and trusted account contacts may also intervene. Our simplified map remains a design model.